

Annual Leave Policy (United Kingdom)

Jurisdiction: United Kingdom | Effective date: 1 April 2026 | Version 3.2 | Owner: HR Advisory Team

1. Statutory Entitlement

All full-time employees are entitled to a minimum of 5.6 weeks (28 days) of paid annual leave per leave year, which may include the 8 English bank holidays. Part-time employees receive a pro-rata entitlement calculated as 5.6 times their normal working week, capped at 28 days.

2. Leave Year and Carry-Over

The company leave year runs from 1 April to 31 March. Employees may carry over a maximum of 5 unused days into the next leave year with line manager approval. Carried-over days must be used before 30 June or they are forfeited. Statutory leave that could not be taken due to maternity leave or long-term sickness may be carried over for up to 18 months.

3. Sickness During Annual Leave

If an employee falls sick during booked annual leave and provides a fit note covering the period, the affected days are reclassified as sick leave and the annual leave days are returned to the employee's balance.

4. Notice Requirements for Booking Leave

Employees must give notice of at least twice the length of the leave requested. For example, a request for 5 days of leave requires at least 10 working days' notice. The company may refuse a request by giving counter-notice equal to the length of the leave requested.

5. Worked Examples

Working pattern	Weekly days	Annual entitlement
Full-time	5	28 days (incl. bank holidays)
Part-time	3	16.8 days, rounded up to 17
Part-time	2	11.2 days, rounded up to 11.5